5.3 Migration Policies

Policies to address the problem of migration in developing countries like India essentially aim at the following:

- To reduce the volume of migration: As a large part of migration is a reflection of poverty and insecurity faced by large sections of the rural people, the focus of intervention has to be in rural areas. Rural development policies to reduce poverty and insecurity would be essential to reduce the rate of migration.
- To redirect the migrant streams: Redirection of migrant streams, away from big metropolitan cities is a desirable policy option. This policy can help in reducing spatial inequalities by suitable strategies, such as developing a more dispersed pattern of urbanisation.

Recap

- Change in population occurs due to births, deaths and migration.
- The mobility of population in rural areas is greater than that of the urban areas.
- Marriage is the major factor responsible for women's mobility in India and in Tamil Nadu.
- Occupation is the major factor responsible for male migrants in India.
- The extent and nature of migration in any society is basically determined by the nature of the development process experienced by that society.
- The poorer sections of the people migrate for survival, but migrants from better-off sections migrate to improve their living standards.

Exercise

GPMTXQ

I. Choose the correct answer

1. According to the 2011 census, the total population of India was _____.
   a) 121 crore b) 221 crore
   c) 102 crore d) 100 crore
2. _____ has recorded the maximum number of emigrants.
   a) Ramanathapuram b) Coimbatore
   c) Chennai d) Vellore
3. During 2015, _____ of illiterates were migrants from Tamil Nadu.
   a) 7% b) 175% c) 23% d) 9%
4. The poorer sections of the population migrate _____.
   a) as a survival strategy
   b) to improve their living standards
   c) as a service
   d) to get experience

II. Fill in the blanks

1. Migration is enumerated on _____ and _____ bases.
2. The mobility of population in rural areas is _____ than urban areas.
3. In rural India, as per census 2011, _____ percent of the population are counted as migrants.
4. _____ is the major reason for female migration.
5. Any migrant stream would consist of _____ sub streams.

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